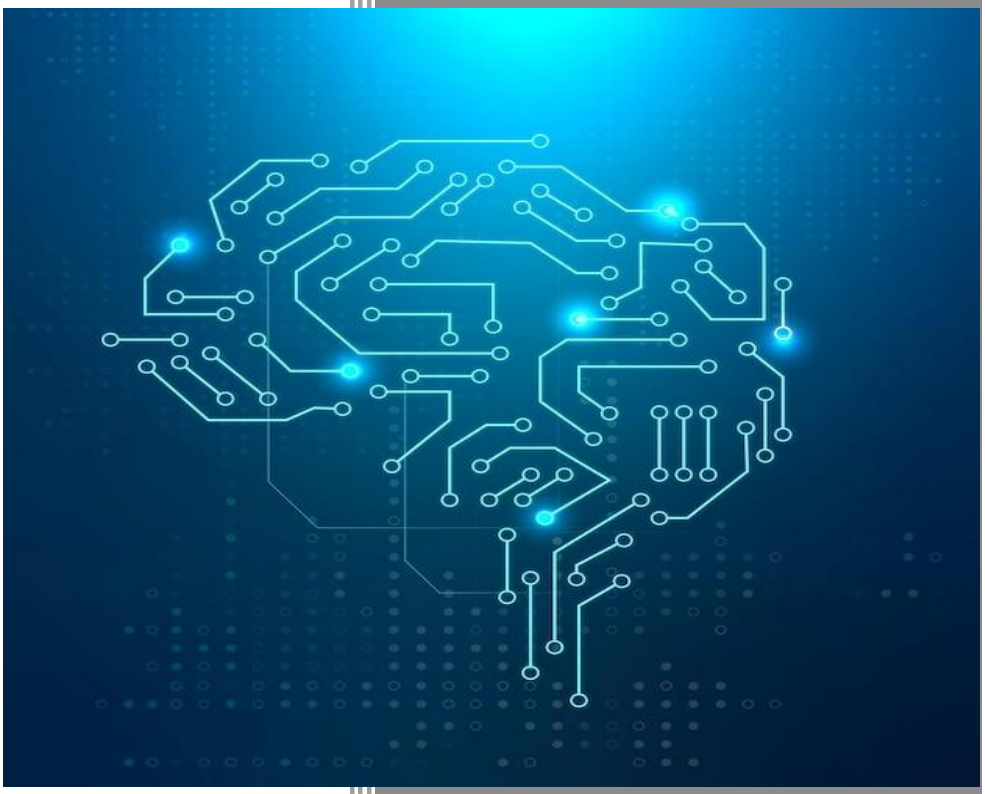
2026

AI sub-strategy



Strategy & Change Group Tech

SEB

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SEB AI sub-strategy

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1. Introduction, Purpose and Scope

Embracing the AI Paradigm shift

We stand at the threshold of a transformation more profound than anything witnessed in the history of modern business. Artificial Intelligence is not just another technology trend, it represents a profound shift in how organizations operate, collaborate, and deliver value. The disruption AI brings dwarfs the impact of both the Industrial Revolution and the emergence of the internet. Where those revolutions redefined production and communication, AI fundamentally changes our way of working, our roles, our decision-making, and the very fabric of our work, extremely fast. This moment calls for urgent attention and decisive action. To ignore or underestimate the capabilities of AI is to risk being left behind in an era where transformation is not optional, but necessary for survival and success. The organizations that recognize the magnitude of this paradigm shift and act deliberately to harness its power will shape the future.
This sub-strategy therefore distinguishes clearly between current capabilities, near-term execution priorities, and longer-term strategic ambition. SEB must act on the possibilities and prepare for the radical changes that lie ahead. AI is the catalyst for this radical shift, but the necessary transformation needs to be planned and executed.

SEBs Stance
Artificial Intelligence (AI) is a core enabler of SEB's enterprise strategy, strengthening customer value, operational excellence, and long-term resilience. In line with SEB's Information and Communication Technology Strategy (ICT), AI is an augmentation of how SEB designs, delivers, and operates services. It does not replace core banking principles, accountability, or regulatory obligations.

The purpose of this AI sub-strategy is to define SEB direction, priorities, and execution approach, for adopting and scaling AI in a responsible, compliant, and value-driven manner. The strategy clarifies how AI contributes to enterprise outcomes and how SEB transitions from experimentation to industrialized, trusted, and sovereign AI capabilities.

The scope covers the entire SEB Group, including business divisions, Group Staff and Support functions and subsidiaries. AI is defined broadly as systems that perform tasks associated with intelligent human behavior, including machine learning, Generative AI, and agent-based AI systems.

Security boundary and linkage to Cybersecurity sub-strategy, this AI sub-strategy covers security topics that are specific to AI solutions (model behavior, prompt and retrieval/grounding risks, and agent tool execution). It does not replace SEB's cyber security baseline. Enterprise cyber security requirements and security control standards are defined in the Cybersecurity sub-strategy. Where AI changes the attack surface or risk level, this sub-strategy defines the AI-specific guardrails and governance expectations that must be applied, together with the Cybersecurity sub-strategy. References in this document to advanced, agentic, or autonomous AI represent a directional ambition governed by horizon-based execution, risk tiering, and explicit accountability. They do not imply current maturity or unrestricted autonomy and must always be interpreted in the context of SEB's regulatory, operational, and risk constraints.

Approach Strategy

SEB applies a horizon-based execution model to balance near-term value creation with long-term transformation:
Horizon 1 (0–12 months): Improve existing processes using available AI capabilities.
Horizon 2 (0–24 months): Redesign priority processes with AI embedded as a core orchestration component.
Horizon 3 (0–36 months): Introduce controlled, potentially disruptive, agent-based operating models.

All horizons run in parallel, enabling SEB to deliver immediate value while systematically investing in future capabilities. Capabilities described under Horizon 2 and 3 should be read as intentional future design targets rather than statements of current operating maturity.

AI in Relation to ICT- and Data Management Strategy

This AI sub-strategy is an integral part of SEB Group's ICT Strategy and shall be applied in conjunction with it. AI systems are ICT systems and are therefore subject to the same architectural principles, governance requirements, security controls, and operational resilience expectations.
AI at scale is fundamentally dependent on governed data and knowledge. SEB's Data Management Strategy provides the foundation for trusted, explainable, and compliant AI through established ownership, quality management, metadata, lineage, and lawful use. AI does not replace data management; it increases its importance.
Where these prerequisites are not met, AI adoption is restricted to low-risk, productivity-oriented use cases until foundational gaps are addressed. Data and knowledge quality determine whether AI can be trusted.

2. Market Forces and Customer Expectations

General Perspective – AI as a Structural Differentiator

AI is reshaping financial services by becoming a core feature across the value chain. Automation, insights, and decision support are now standard, making service delivery, intelligence, personalization, speed, and proactive engagement, the key to competitive advantage rather than product offerings.
AI has evolved from boosting efficiency to supporting overall value propositions. This shift enables end-to-end processes where humans and machines collaborate seamlessly, improving customer outcomes, operational leverage, and trust at scale.
As customers are expected to also use their own AI agents to interact with banks, institutions must appeal to both human clients and AI systems. The channel model must move toward human-centered approaches when needed and machine-optimized interactions wherever possible, making SEB "AI agent friendly".

Macro View - AI in Finance

AI is becoming embedded across industries and increasingly across the financial value chain. In banking, AI accelerates a structural shift toward data-driven, automated, and insight-led processes spanning risk management, customer engagement, operations, and compliance.
Customer expectations are evolving toward always-on, predictive, and personalized interaction. Over time, customer AI agents are expected to search, compare, negotiate, and act on behalf of customers. This requires banks to become AI-ready for secure, explainable, and compliant machine-to-machine interaction.

At the same time, regulatory requirements such as the EU AI Act and the Digital Operational Resilience Act raise expectations on transparency, auditability, data lineage, and lifecycle controls. AI therefore becomes not only a technological capability, but a strategic asset underpinning competitiveness, compliance, and operational resilience.

Corporate Customer Perspective – AI-Ready Banking

While personal interactions remain central for trust and long-term relationships, corporate clients now operate in automated, data-driven environments with fast, system-to-system decisions. Their expectations are shifting towards proactive, predictive, and programmable banking. AI presents an opportunity to strengthen SEB's position by offering integrations that are AI ready as well as providing new, AI augmented products and services.

- Seamlessly integrate with ERP, treasury, and risk systems using secure APIs and events.
- Provide real-time insights into liquidity, risk, compliance, and optimization.
- Offer machine-accessible services for client AI agents to act within set mandates and controls.

Retail Customer Perspective – Personalized, Predictive, and Effortless

Retail customers want banking to be intuitive, seamless, and personalized, with minimal friction. As AI becomes embedded in everyday consumer tools, expectations for personalization, relevance, and immediacy rise sharply.

- AI should proactively anticipate customer needs and offer relevant guidance at the right time.
- AI must simplify financial information into clear, actionable advice tailored to individuals.
- Support hybrid interactions, human advisors, digital channels, and customer AI assistants, while maintaining trust and continuity.

AI is shifting competitive differentiation from products toward how services are delivered. Sustainable advantage increasingly depends on intelligence, personalization, speed, and proactive engagement rather than on pricing or feature differentiation alone.
Both corporate and retail customers increasingly operate in automated, data-driven environments. Corporate customers expect programmable banking capabilities that integrate seamlessly into their own systems, while retail customers expect intuitive, predictive, and effortless financial services across channels.
SEB's AI strategy therefore prioritizes AI-enabled end-to-end processes that combine human judgment with machine execution in a controlled and transparent manner.

3. Current State of AI at SEB

Operating model

SEB's current AI operating model follows a hub-and-spoke approach designed to ensure strategic alignment while enabling local execution at scale. In this setup, the central hub provides strategic leadership by defining the AI direction together with the business, establishing governance frameworks, best practices, and forums such as the AI Advisory Council, and supporting business units in the development and deployment of AI use cases. The spokes, in turn, are accountable for identifying AI opportunities within their domains, owning and managing AI solutions throughout their lifecycle, and building and sustaining the required AI competencies to realize business value.

Technology Landscape

SEB uses a modern, multi-cloud platform for AI and machine learning. GCP offers a high-code environment with scalable tools like Vertex AI, while Microsoft Azure's low-code ecosystem includes Copilot Studio for rapid development of agents and M365 Copilot for AI assisted personal productivity. GitHub Copilot supports developers with efficient code generation and review. Current setup allows access to many different models and while this offers flexibility, it also leads to complexity, cost and governance challenges.

Strategic Competencies, Skills and Maturity

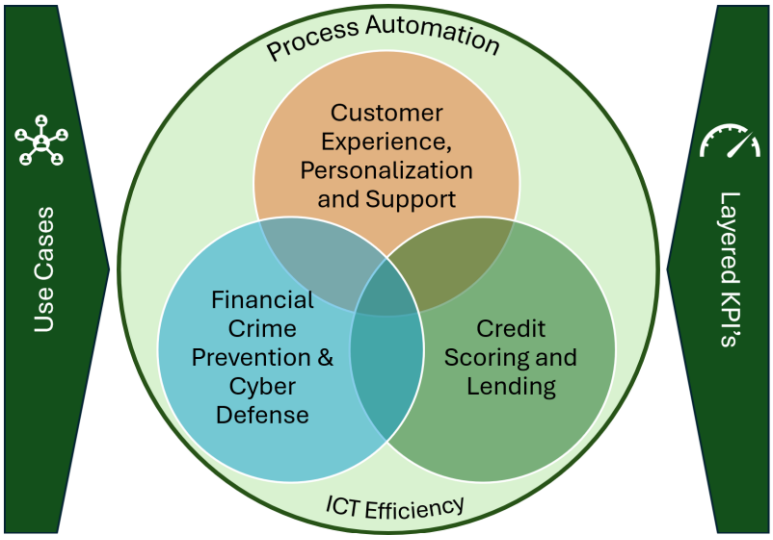
SEB has become attractive to top AI talent, building strong expertise with Data Scientists and Machine Learning Engineers throughout the organization. Alongside AIOps, these roles are highly in demand in Europe, emphasizing the need for an effective Tech/HR strategy to attract, retain, and scale talent.
SEB maintains a solid Responsible AI foundation through its AI Advisory Council, compliance with EU AI Act, and structured risk frameworks like AACA. These strengths enable SEB to deliver diverse AI use cases. Despite rapid growth in AI capabilities. However, maturity varies across divisions, especially in scalability, governance, and architecture.

Use cases

In the current state, AI is applied across several business domains with tangible value, while varying degrees of maturity. A significant share of current use cases focuses on document processing and process automation, where AI is used to extract, classify, and interpret unstructured information, reduce manual handling, and increase efficiency and consistency in processes. Customer segmentation and analysis represent another well-established area enabling deeper insights into customer behavior, needs, and preferences, and supporting more data-driven advisory, and engagement. In addition, financial crime prevention is a critical and long-standing application area, where AI supports detection, monitoring, and investigation of suspicious patterns and activities, complementing rule-based approaches and enhancing the SEB's ability to manage financial crime risks at scale.

4. High potential areas for Application of AI

Although AI can deliver notable gains in efficiency and productivity across various domains, certain areas present especially strategic opportunities. As a result, SEB concentrates its AI investments on enterprise level, targeting these areas across all three strategic horizons. It's important to recognize that personal productivity AI, (within an area) is fundamentally different from AI acting as part of institutional processes. But both will boost productivity and efficiency.



Customer Experience, Personalization and Support

Objective: Deliver proactive, personalized, and channel-agnostic customer interaction at scale.
As well as Machine-to machine optimized channels that position SEB as preferred Bank for Agentic interaction.
Focus areas include intelligent service agents (chat and voice), next-best-action personalization, financial coaching, advisory support, and complaint handling. MCP services and API's that offer a comprehensive set of actions.

Credit Scoring and Lending

Objective: Improve the speed, accuracy, and control of credit processes and decision support, while preserving established accountability, governance, and mandatory human involvement for high-risk credit decisions.
Focus areas include credit scoring, mortgage pricing and eligibility, loan processing and servicing, and early warning and collections.

Financial Crime Prevention and Cyber defense

Objective: Enhance detection quality, minimize false positives, and enable real-time responses with responsible AI use in financial crime prevention. Focus areas are KYC, transaction monitoring, fraud detection, sanctions screening, and AI-supported analyst workflows. For security operations, AI must follow risk-tiered governance and existing cybersecurity policies, supporting defensive tasks without altering SEB's baseline standards.

Process Automation and ICT Efficiency

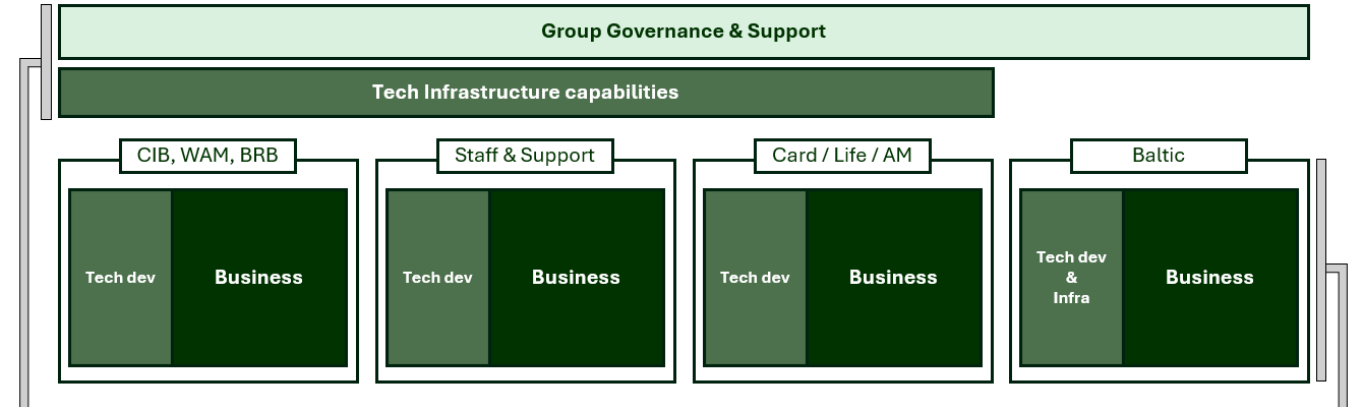
Objective: Reduce manual work, improve quality, and increase operational resilience.
Focus areas include onboarding and document intelligence, back-office automation, service operations, and personal productivity incl. developer productivity.
Focus areas include high volumes of data (Business Services, Group Finance, CRO, Real Estate Premises), knowledge-intense (Regulations, Internal Rules) and the intersect of both (Risk Management).

5. Developed Operating Model

To scale AI responsibly and generate durable business value, SEB requires an AI operating model that combines governance, technology, and organizational readiness. The objective is to ensure AI is deployed safely, consistently, and at enterprise scale while maintaining regulatory compliance and accountability.

Operationalizing AI

Scaling AI requires enterprise alignment across governance, data lineage, and agent orchestration. SEB will evolve from distributed experimentation to enterprise-grade AI capabilities built on scalable, secure, compliant, and reusable foundations. The operating model does not change established Group ICT delivery principles or subsidiary responsibilities, but it defines governance, shared assets and lifecycle accountability, while preserving decentralized delivery and local ownership.
The developed operating model has a strengthened "Hub" to cover more common enablers and support, and clarifies Technology development areas, as responsible for lifecycle management of in-house built AI-systems.



Model entity	Contributing functions	Provides
AI HUB Group Governance & Support	Strategy and Change Control functions HR SEBx SEB Strategy Execution Market Communication	**Coordinated group-wide governance and support** ▪ Strategy, governance, standards, reference architecture ▪ Risk, Security and Compliance guidance and oversight ▪ Up-skill, Talent Management, Change Management ▪ RnD and support for product development and tech/business transformation ▪ How we communicate AI in SEB
Tech Infra capabilities	Infrastructure & Cyber defense Developer experience	**Shared infrastructural assets** E.g., Cyber defense, Workplace, Developer platform, AI platform, Hosting
Technology dev	Technology	**Delivery** and lifecycle ownership of AI systems.
Divisions, Group functions and Subsidiaries	CIB, WAM, BRB, Staff & support, Baltic, Card, Life, AM	**Digital product development & infra (Baltics)** Use-case identification and realization, business value ownership, adoption and change

SPOKES

This structure ensures strategic control, delivery capacity, and local innovation, enabling SEB to scale AI consistently across the organization while maintaining speed, compliance, and long-term resilience.

Technology owns how AI systems operate, including platforms, architectures, and technical controls. Business divisions and control functions own business outcomes, value realization, and what AI is allowed to know and do, including mandates, data context, and risk boundaries.

6. AI Technology Framework

AI is a tool, not the objective. SEB's core purpose continues to be providing trustworthy advice and capital to our clients. All AI systems and agents must operate within clearly defined processes. While AI may plan and act within its assigned mandate, it is subject to the same requirements as human or traditional automated actors.

Guiding principles

Financial service processes are governed by strict mandatory requirements, including record keeping, audit trails, identification, authorization, control mechanisms, and transaction screening. Decision-support and limited execution mandates may be delegated to AI within clearly defined, deterministic workflows and policy constraints. Accountability for decisions, particularly in high-risk domains such as credit, financial crime, and customer commitments, always remains with explicitly accountable human roles, supported by mandatory human-in-the-loop controls. This ensures responsible delivery of advice and capital.

For example:
AI should be used to augment design, analysis, and execution within deterministic processes, not to replace deterministic control logic itself. Looking ahead, SEB will use AI to interpret customer demand, comply with regulatory requirements, and develop innovative financial services.
SEB already has established solutions for managing autonomous agents (humans) and for secure machine-to-machine communication. AI should consequently be integrated into these existing mechanisms.

- Identity and access management
- API management
- Process management
- Separation of duties with maker/checker support
- Data management
- Monitoring solutions
- Robotic solutions

AI security-by-design (AI-specific controls)
In addition to SEB's general ICT security baseline, AI solutions must address security risks that are specific to models, prompts, retrieval/grounding, and agentic execution. This includes:

- Protecting against prompt injection and unsafe instruction following, especially when external content is used for grounding or when the model can call tools.
- Preventing unintended data exposure by enforcing data classification and approved data sources, limiting retrieval to least privilege/need-to-know, and applying output controls appropriate to the use case and channel.
- Controlling tool access (what an agent can call/do) using allow-lists, policy enforcement, and explicit constraints for high-impact actions (e.g., limits and required approvals).
- Managing model and dependency supply-chain risk through model provenance, controlled versions, approvals before change, and monitoring for unintended changes in behavior or performance after updates.
- Preventing data leakage by enforcing data classification and approved data sources, limiting retrieval to least privilege/need-to-know, and applying appropriate output controls.
- Controlling tool access (what an agent can call/do) using allow-lists, policy enforcement, and constraints on actions (e.g., limits, approvals, and reversibility where relevant).
- Managing model and dependency supply-chain risk through model provenance, controlled versions, approvals before change, and monitoring of updates and performance/risk drift.

These requirements are expressed as guardrails and governance triggers in this sub-strategy. Detailed security standards and technical control patterns are defined in the Cybersecurity sub-strategy.

AI agents may use APIs when permitted by access management. To facilitate AI integration, APIs can be wrapped with protocols such as Model Context Protocol (MCP), while keeping interfaces consistent. Similarly, AI agents can interact with GUIs when provided with suitable tools.
We already assign workload identities to software running on servers. By extending this to AI agents, giving each a unique identity, we can use identity and access management solutions to ensure agents are authenticated and only authorized for permitted actions.

In processes such as loan origination, we will deploy multiple models and AI agents, each with a specific role, such as providing advice, credit scoring, probability of default calculation, or loan approval, within deterministic workflows. Maker/checker patterns will be used to monitor and detect anomalous agent behavior.
Although the vision of fully autonomous AIs managing entire business lines (e.g., mortgages) is a long-term goal, our current focus is to deploy AI agents that enhance discrete tasks within established processes.
Ongoing business and ICT development is essential. We should use AI to support humans in redesigning products, user interfaces, processes, and architectures, freeing capacity for higher-value design and decision-making.

Integrating AI agents will often require upgrades to infrastructure and applications. For instance, process orchestration may be missing, call center infrastructure may lack necessary data access, some applications may not have sufficient APIs, or data needed for retrieval-augmented generation (RAG) may be unavailable.
AI solutions might also require new types of databases, such as vector databases.

We expect AI to play a critical role in upgrading and building the capabilities needed for large-scale adoption. However, these advancements will increase maintenance demands and costs. While some maintenance tasks can, and should, be automated by AI, the overall volume of maintenance is expected to grow.

Cost Control for AI Systems

As the adoption of large language models (LLMs) increases and AI becomes more integrated within our technology stack, operational costs are expected to rise. To effectively manage these costs, it is essential to design AI systems with anticipated high compute consumption in mind. This requires building architectures that are both efficient and cost-effective. For intensive inference workloads and model training, Sferical is identified as the preferred platform, ensuring that resource utilization remains optimized and expenses are controlled.

Model Governance

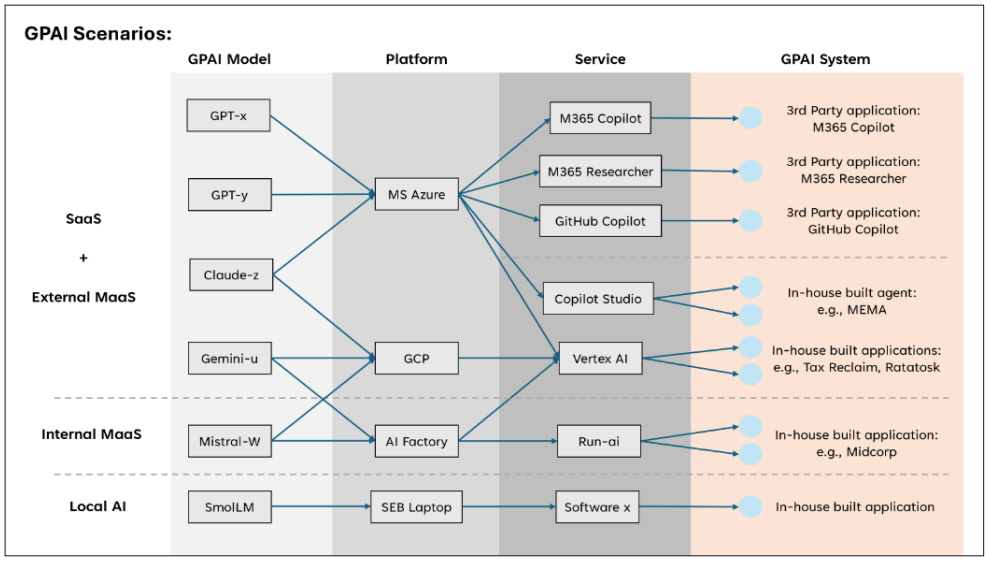
SEB applies centralized model governance to ensure quality, security, compliance, and operational efficiency.
A key governance goal is to reduce the number of model vendors, encouraging divisions and functions to focus on a smaller subset of providers that align with their specific needs and build lasting relationships and expertise.
For example, Risk should prioritize vendors with proven strengths in financial services risk modeling, fostering organizational competence and infrastructure tailored to those providers. Limiting model diversity also helps manage costs, particularly when large-scale vectorization is required.

AI Models are made available through standardized, pre-packaged services that include routing, fallback, and usage policies. Central routing principles are applied to select appropriate models based on use case, risk classification, data sensitivity, cost, and performance. Providers and models are continuously reassessed as capabilities, regulations, and market conditions evolve. Over time, value creation is expected to shift from selecting individual models to orchestrating multiple models dynamically based on context, cost, performance, and risk. The strategy therefore anticipates an abstraction layer where model selection is centrally governed and optimized while remaining transparent to solution teams and end users.

Individual teams do not independently select or integrate foundation models. Model access is provided as a shared enterprise capability, aligned with SEB's governance, security, and resilience requirements.
Models embedded in 3rd party services, i.e., SaaS and COTS (Commodity of the shelf) should be evaluated and governed according to EU AI Act and other relevant regulatory requirements.

From a horizon 3 perspective training and provision of Domain specific models (DSM) could prove valuable for SEB strategically, when Commercial model + RAG is insufficient or poses regulatory challenges. Especially when combined with the sovereign capability that Sferical provides. Those specialized models will also be provided as a shared enterprise capability.

Governance of General-Purpose Artificial Intelligence (GPAI) at SEB is described in the picture below where the columns: GPAI model, Platform and Service corresponds to the "AI Hub" in the developed operating model and the GPAI Systems corresponds to the "Technology areas" in the model.



Model governance at SEB covers the full AI lifecycle, including approval, monitoring, periodic reassessment, controlled replacement, and decommissioning.

Model changes are treated as managed risk events and executed through established ICT change, validation, and governance processes.

7. AI Agent Integration - Risks and Best Practices

AI Agents using Human Interfaces

AI agents are software entities leveraging AI to perceive their environment, make decisions, and act to achieve defined objectives. As digital workers, they can plan tasks, utilize tools, and adapt based on their experiences. Their flexibility enables automation of both simple and complex workflows, sometimes with minimal training.

Robotic Process Automation vs. AI

Traditionally, many business processes have relied on Robotic Process Automation (RPA), which operates through deterministic rules and strict controls. RPA is specifically designed for repetitive tasks that demand transparency and reliability. However, integrating AI into these processes introduces additional risk and complexity because AI behavior can be less predictable and may expose new vulnerabilities.
Therefore, tasks suited for deterministic Robotic Process Automation should remain with RPA solutions. AI-enabled automation is introduced where ambiguity, language understanding, or contextual reasoning is required, and only with appropriate guardrails.

Security Concerns with AI Agents

Generative AI systems, including Large Language Models (LLMs), introduce security risks that differ from deterministic software. Key risks include prompt injection (malicious instructions embedded in inputs), unintended data exposure through overly broad retrieval/grounding or logging, and increased third-party/dependency exposure through model providers, plugins, and tool integrations. When AI agents are granted access to execute actions across systems, the impact of compromised credentials, misconfiguration, or actions outside the agent's intended mandate can increase. Risk is higher when agents can initiate high-impact actions (e.g., customer communications, data changes, or payment-related activities) without strong constraints and oversight. Risk reduction depends on designing processes and architectures where agents operate within explicit mandates: deterministic orchestration for critical steps, least-privilege identities, controlled tool access, logging/traceability for agent decisions and tool calls, monitoring, and the ability to intervene (suspend/rollback). These AI-specific guardrails are defined in this sub-strategy; enterprise cyber security control standards.

Server-Side AI Automation APIs vs. Client-Side AI Automation Using UIs

When human interaction is required, user interfaces should be designed to be user-friendly. Conversely, when AI agents are expected to interact, APIs should be built with AI agent compatibility in mind, ensuring seamless and secure integration.

Development efforts should prioritize building integrations that are straightforward and accessible also for AI agents. We need to provide MCP enabled server side APIs and client-side APIs for on-device agentic automation, e.g. through AppFunctions on Android. The recent rapid growth of client-side agent frameworks indicates a future where some orchestrations are done at the "app level" by agents running on the end user's device and some orchestrations are done server side using server side MCP enabled APIs.

The threat vectors and liability scenarios (e.g., fraud) differ between client- and server-side automation and are expected to increase coordination, monitoring, and investigation demand across cyber security and financial crime prevention teams.
The threat vectors and liability scenarios w.r.t. for example fraud are different for client- and server-side automation and will further stress cyber security and financial crime prevention units.

For the time being, such agents pose too high security risk and should be blocked (with an exception management process) inside SEB, but on the customer side this is not possible, even though we expect other corporations to act similarly.

AI Agent Guardrails

AI agents are AI models equipped with tools to act autonomously within defined processes, performing tasks rather than replacing entire workflows. To leverage these agents safely and responsibly, SEB enforces a comprehensive set of guardrails that ensure strict control boundaries, transparent oversight, and robust defensive architecture.

- **Clear Ownership & Lifecycle Governance**
  Assign accountable owners for each agent and include them within ICT governance, model registries, and operational resilience frameworks (aligned with DORA, EU AI Act). This ensures agents are properly managed throughout their lifecycle.
- **Policy-as-Code Guardrails**
  Enforce hard constraints on agent actions, such as transaction limits, data access levels, and allowed systems. All actions are validated against these rules before execution to maintain operational control.
- **Human-in-the-Loop for High-Impact Decisions**
  Require mandatory human approval for sensitive actions, including credit decisions, customer-facing commitments, and transactions, while reserving autonomy for low-risk, reversible tasks.
- **Auditability & Explainability**
  Log every decision, tool invocation, and data reference. Ensure agents can explain their actions and reasoning to enable regulatory compliance and facilitate incident reconstruction.
- **Isolated, Least-Privilege Architecture**
  Operate agents in sandboxed environments with separate workload identities and tightly scoped API permissions. This prevents lateral movement and ensures controlled access to sensitive customer- or transaction data.
- **Continuous Monitoring & Kill-Switch Capabilities**
  Monitor agents in real time for anomalies, policy violations, or drift, with the ability to immediately suspend or roll back any agent if necessary.
- **Rigorous Validation & Red-Team Testing**
  Stress-test agents under adversarial, ambiguous, and edge-case scenarios before production release. Continuously evaluate performance and risk to maintain operational integrity.
- **Process Automation Oversight & Inferencing**
  Business Process Management (BPM), case management, and low-code/no-code platforms must provide AI agent-specific monitoring and governance capabilities.
- **Knowledge-Bounded Execution**
  AI agents must operate within explicitly defined knowledge boundaries, using only approved sources and prohibited from making decisions based on undocumented assumptions or inferred rules. These constraints are enforced through architecture, not policy alone.

This structured approach ensures SEB's AI agents operate safely, remain compliant, and deliver reliable automation within business processes.

8. Knowledge Management as a Strategic Enabler

Competitive differentiation will increasingly come from context, domain knowledge, and trusted execution rather than from access to foundation models alone. AI without institutional knowledge remains a productivity tool. AI grounded in institutional knowledge becomes a strategic differentiator. For SEB, structured, governed and machine-readable knowledge must act as the foundation for domain-specific AI, trusted automation and agentic orchestration. Knowledge Management therefore shifts from a support function to a core capability layer in the AI architecture.

Strategic Rationale

The real choice is not whether to invest in Knowledge Management, but whether we want generic AI or SEB-native intelligence. AI models derive value from the context they operate in. Without structured knowledge, output remains generic, hallucination risk increases, regulatory exposure grows and autonomous workflows cannot operate safely. With a governed knowledge layer, responses become context-aware, automation becomes compliant and AI agents can execute end-to-end processes.

As foundation models commoditize, differentiation shifts to proprietary context. SEB's competitive advantage will increasingly reside in machine-readable knowledge such as product logic, risk frameworks, credit policies, regulatory interpretations, internal decision history, process design and customer interaction patterns.
In a highly regulated environment (DORA, EU AI Act, MiCA, GDPR), explainability and traceability are mandatory.
A structured knowledge layer enables source attribution, policy control, transparent decision logic and auditable AI behavior. Without this foundation, large-scale AI adoption will remain constrained by risk and compliance concerns.

Directional guidance

Strategically, SEB will progressively introduce a clear responsibility for producers and owners of unstructured information, ensuring that relevant information is transformed into institutional knowledge that is accessible and ready for AI consumption. This mirrors the approach for structured data, where data producers are accountable for making their data available to other systems through data products such as APIs and data pipelines.
Producers and owners of unstructured information, such as instructions, policies, and guidelines, should be prepared to provide machine-readable knowledge that enables AI systems to acquire necessary skills and operate effectively. E.g. markdown versions of information, vectorization and MCP-services. Which should be governed but be also highly automated.
This shift positions the management of unstructured data as a critical enabler for SEB-native intelligence and supports trusted, compliant automation across business processes.

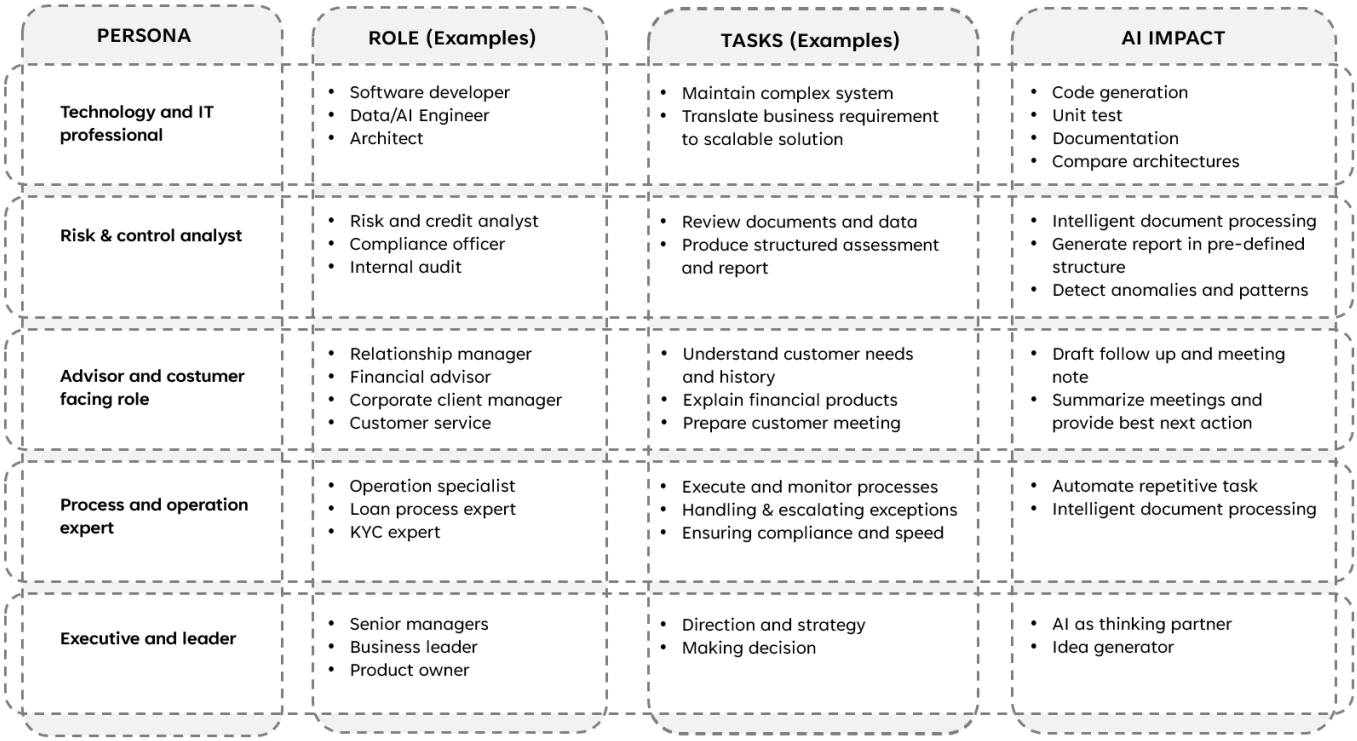
Approach

Horizon	Knowledge Maturity	AI Capability
H1	**Structured** documentation & governance. Initially centralized.	AI-assisted productivity
H2	**Contextualized** domain knowledge. Operationalized structured knowledge inside AI workflows.	Embedded process intelligence
H3	**Executable** institutional memory. Policy-aware autonomous agents built on executable institutional memory	Autonomous, policy-aware agents

9. AI transforming roles and ways of working

AI is transforming work at SEB by enhancing human expertise across all roles. It speeds up tasks for IT professionals, risk analysts, advisors, operations specialists, and executives, making processes more efficient, enabling smarter decision-making, and supporting personalized interactions. As AI evolves, it will continue to reshape responsibilities and enable new ways of working, making it central to SEB's future operations.

This persona matrix highlights how AI's impact differs by role while fundamentally changing work for many.



Accountability for Skills, Capability and Change

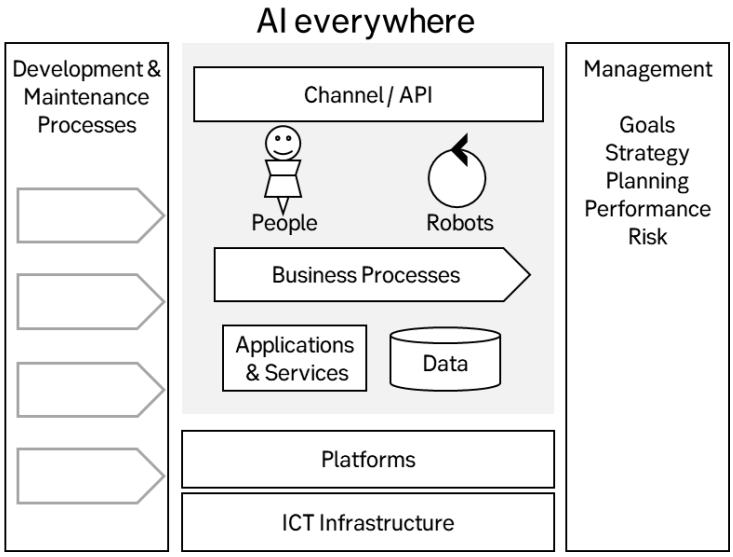
The responsibility of catering for up-skill and recruitment as well as organizational changes, falls on the respective line organization with support from the HR-function.

Group HR provides necessary strategic guidance and operational support to drive the transformation on an enterprise level. This transformational shift, catalyzed by AI, will have wide impact far beyond technology, and will require well executed change management, communication and active leadership to be successful.

Responsibility	Primary Owner	Supporting Function	Success Factors
People & skills strategy	HR	Technology	Well defined workforce demand in each part of the organization. Roles, Skill matrix, etc.
Up-skilling	Line Organization	HR function	Common and role-based AI learning paths
Critical competence sourcing	Line Organization	HR function	Global search, re-location, remote working exceptions
Organizational Changes	Line Organization	HR function	Change Management, Communication, Active Leadership

AI for Personal Productivity vs. Process Participation

AI is now a standard productivity layer at SEB, automating routine tasks and accelerating analysis, communication, and decision-making for developers, analysts, advisors, and operational roles. As AI handles manual work, employees focus on oversight, advisory, and complex problem-solving. To fully realize these benefits, SEB invests in AI literacy and targeted upskilling, ensuring responsible and effective use across everyday workflows.



SEB distinguishes:

- **Personal productivity use** - employees use AI agents under their own identity and are accountable for outcomes.
- **Process-integrated AI** - agents operate within SEB's delivery and control frameworks, requiring additional governance, monitoring, and human oversight for high-impact actions.

In summary, as AI transforms productivity and process participation, SEB's strategy centers on clear role distinctions, robust governance, and continuous upskilling to ensure clarity, accountability, and responsible adoption.

AI in Software Development

AI is now deeply embedded in SEB's software development lifecycle, significantly enhancing solution quality, accelerating delivery, and improving system resilience. AI should be used in activities such as design, coding, testing, review, and architectural design, but keeping the decisions privileged to humans. AI should act as a catalyst for both technical excellence and organizational agility going forward.

In effect, the traditional boundaries between developer, architect, team leader, and project manager are dissolving. With AI's support, a developer can take on multiple roles, seamlessly transitioning between technical and leadership responsibilities.

This evolution in role definition calls for a new skillset where technical mastery is still valuable, but the ability to understand and manage the entire product value chain becomes paramount. As AI empowers individuals to take on broader responsibilities, the emphasis shifts toward strategic thinking, cross-functional collaboration, and holistic problem-solving.

Organizationally, this transformation favors smaller, agile teams augmented by AI, making large, specialized project groups less effective. Multi-skilled teams can leverage AI throughout the development process, from initial design to deployment, enabling architects, developers, and engineers to refine design patterns, identify technical risks, and propose robust, scalable improvements.

Institutionalizing AI-Driven Co-Creation and Auditing

A strategic objective for SEB is to embed AI-driven co-creation and auditing into every stage of the development process. This approach ensures that solutions are delivered to market more rapidly and are also more innovative, future-proof, and closely aligned with SEB's overarching business objectives. Through systematic AI integration, co-creation and auditing become standard practices, supporting both technical rigor and business alignment.

Buy or Build: Rethinking Solution Sourcing

The productivity gains from AI-assisted solution design and code development have significantly shifted the build-or-buy equation. Options that were once impractical to develop internally are now viable alternatives, thanks to advances in AI. As a result, SEB recommends considering in-house development for non-commodity applications before choosing to purchase third-party solutions. This approach can help avoid licensing costs, change and, in some cases, reduce certain categories of third-party risk, while introducing new risk considerations that must be governed.

Development Focus: AI Systems and Business Solutions

A considerable portion of development efforts will naturally focus on the creation of AI systems themselves. However, the core objective remains the delivery of effective solutions that address business problems. AI should not be applied where deterministic solutions offer faster, better, and lower-risk results. Instead, AI can be used to build deterministic solutions when appropriate. It is important to recognize that AI is not a universal answer; robust business processes and traditional ICT development remain essential.

Strategic Application of AI in Business and ICT Development

AI is having a profound impact on both business and Information and Communication Technology (ICT) development, often to a greater degree than on the resulting business processes. For example, payment processes must operate in a deterministic manner to ensure reliability and compliance. While deterministic models are essential in such critical processes, the scope for fully autonomous AI-driven creativity is currently limited, especially in the short- to mid-term. Nevertheless, AI is already contributing to the development of improved payment processes and similar business functions at SEB.

Use AI from Inception

From the earliest stages of designing processes, applications, and business models, SEB positions AI not merely as an automation tool but as an intelligent collaborator. This mindset encourages disciplined innovation and technical excellence. Incorporating AI consultation at the inception of projects is recommended as a standard practice. This enables teams to challenge conventional thinking, explore new architectural possibilities, and investigate innovative solutions. Such an approach supports the discovery of novel strategies that can deliver sustainable competitive advantages for SEB.

Trusted and Compliant AI by Design

AI must be designed with compliance, transparency, and resilience embedded from the start. SEB will systematically integrate requirements from the EU AI Act, GDPR, and DORA across the full AI lifecycle, from development to deployment and monitoring. AI systems will follow a risk-tiered approach, including safeguards such as human-in-the-loop controls for high-impact decisions. Core technical capabilities such as logging, lineage tracking, and decision auditability will ensure oversight and accountability. Governance is anchored centrally through ICT asset registration and Generative AI model approvals, ensuring all AI systems are assessed, catalogued, and governed consistently. Technology teams manage how AI systems operate, while business and control functions retain ownership of the data and knowledge shaping AI behavior. This separation enables scale without diluting accountability.

10. Approach - Strategy to Execution

SEB operationalizes the AI strategy through a coordinated, horizon-based execution model integrating planning, governance, and portfolio steering. The aim is to transition from experimentation to industrialization in a controlled, value driven manner.

Winning in Corporate segment

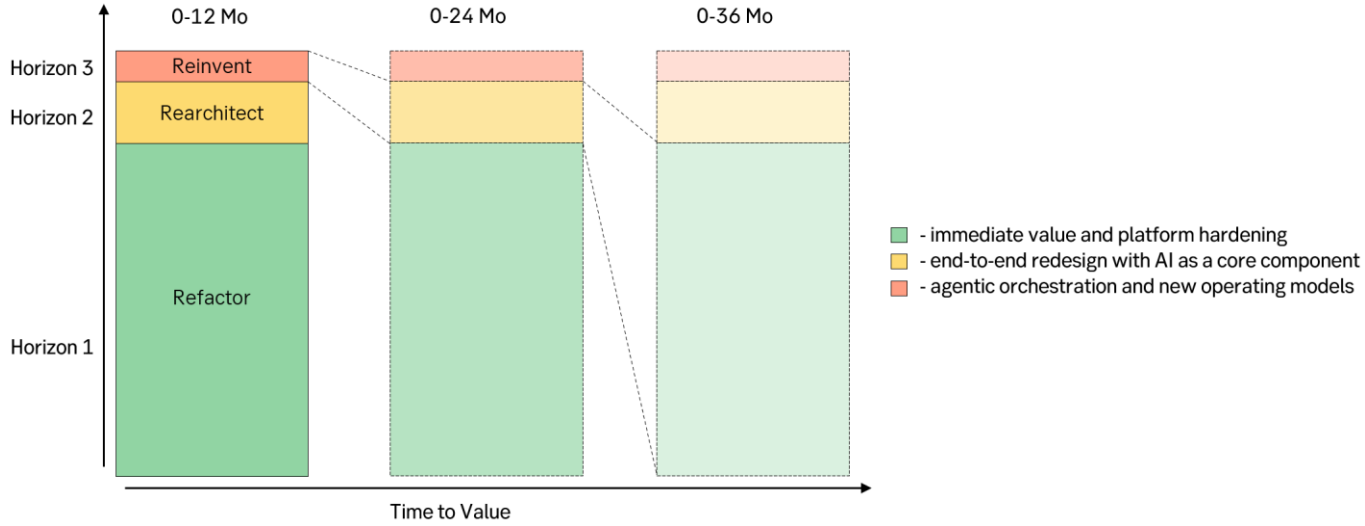
The strategic objective is to become the preferred banking partner in automated corporate ecosystems, trusted by both human decision-makers and their AI counterparts. This requires AI-enabled core processes, strong data foundations, and robust governance to ensure explainability, security, and regulatory compliance. Each step towards this goal building on the previous.

Winning in Retail segment

The goal should be higher satisfaction, stronger loyalty, and improved financial well-being for private customers, delivered at scale. AI is not about replacing human interaction but augmenting it. Advisors gain better insight and decision support, while customers experience faster, more accurate, and more relevant services.

Horizon-Driven Execution Model

Refactor → Rearchitect → Reinvent, Working with all three Horizons simultaneously but with an 80-15-5% focus. Where 80% of the focus should be on Horizon 1, i.e., improving systems and processes with the available capabilities, at any given time.



Horizon 1 - Refactor (augment what exists). Time-to-value: 0–12 months
Goal: Improve throughput, quality, and cost without changing core process designs.

- Focus on a few, high-value use cases with tangible effects.
- Utilize or establish foundational capabilities: governance, data products, model registries, platform services.
- Normalize AI-readiness in processes, architecture, and compliance.
- Strengthen observability, lineage, and regulatory controls.

Horizon 2 - Rearchitect (AI-centric process redesign). Time-to-value: 0–24 months
Goal: Redesign priority journeys end-to-end so AI is built into orchestration, not bolted on.

- Rethinking the whole process with AI in the center and legacy as supporting functions.

- Redesign priority workflows: credit, FCP, onboarding, treasury, customer servicing.
- Deploy agent-based orchestration in back-office domains.
- Introduce AI-first SDLC and integration practices.

Horizon 3 - Reinvent (Agentic + orchestration; disruptive operating model). Time-to-value: 0–36 months
Goal: Introduce controlled autonomy where agents execute multi-step work across systems, with policy and supervision.

- Seeking new business opportunities and areas of application. Up until now, out of scope or out of reach.
- Launch AI-native customer-interaction models and advisory engines.
- Enable secure agent-to-agent financial interactions.
- Scale autonomous capabilities in low-risk domains.

AI integrated in Portfolio Management

Even though AI is of highest strategic importance and progress is measured with specific KPI's, it should not be treated separately from other product development and modernization initiatives. But rather be an integrated part of the solutions wherever it makes the specific solution better.

- Integrate AI initiatives into existing portfolio governance, no standalone AI backlog.
- Prioritize high-impact use cases linked to measurable customer or operational value.
- Apply structured value tracking, delivery milestones, and risk assessments.

When projects can be performed by very small teams using many AI skills and agents, the traditional project overhead will be reduced, perhaps to a point where they will no longer be seen as projects even when the impact in terms of risk and reward remains the same. In an industrial approach to agent-augmented development, project portfolio management activities, e.g. reporting, must be built into the tooling, like today's continuous integration and deployment (CI/CD) automations.

11. Strategic Risk Management

AI is strategic for SEB, but adoption must protect trust, financial stability, and compliance. Risk is built in by design through governed data and knowledge, risk-tiered governance, auditable operations, and resilient ICT foundations aligned with the EU AI Act, DORA, and GDPR.

Interlink to Cybersecurity Sub-strategy
This AI sub-strategy defines AI-specific risk themes, guardrails, and governance triggers for models, retrieval/grounding (e.g., RAG), and agent tool execution. The Cybersecurity sub-strategy remains the authority for enterprise cyber risk management and security control standards. The strategies are applied together when AI solutions are designed, approved, implemented, and operated, so that AI-specific guardrails and the broader cyber security baseline are both addressed.

Risk themes identified and systematically addressed through the principles, guardrails, and execution model defined in this sub-strategy:

- **Regulatory & compliance:** Lifecycle governance aligned to EU AI Act, GDPR, and DORA, supported by clear ownership and evidence (logging/audit trails).
- **Model risk & quality:** Central model governance, standardized access/services (routing, fallback, usage policies), reassessment, and governance of models in third-party services.
- **Security & cyber:** Architecture-first controls (workload identities, least privilege, controlled tool access, API-first integration) to reduce new genAI/agent attack surfaces.
- **Operational resilience:** AI is treated as ICT, with monitoring, operational ownership, and intervention capabilities (e.g., suspend/rollback) as prerequisites for scale.
- **Data & knowledge integrity:** Governed data/knowledge (quality, ownership, lineage, lawful use) is required; otherwise, AI is limited to low-risk productivity use.
- **Decision accountability:** Human-in-the-loop and maker/checker patterns for high-impact actions, with auditable decision logic.

How SEB handles AI risk strategically

SEB scales AI where it can be controlled, evidenced, and operated. The strategy relies on standardization and reuse, clear lifecycle ownership, and resilience through monitoring and rapid intervention when behavior deviates.

- **Risk-tiered adoption:** Faster paths for low-risk use; stricter controls for process-integrated and customer-impacting AI.
- **Governance:** Common guardrails, centralized foundational model (LLM) governance and reference architectures, with federated accountability for delivery and lifecycle.
- **Least privilege by design:** Explicit identities, scoped permissions, and controlled tool use for agents and services.
- **Auditability:** Logging of decisions, tool calls, and data references to support oversight, reporting, and incident reconstruction.
- **Vendor discipline:** Central evaluation and reduced model sprawl to manage cost, risk, and embedded third-party AI.

Across the horizons, SEB increases autonomy only as prerequisites mature. H1 improves within existing controls, H2 redesigns priority processes with embedded governance, and H3 introduces selective agentic models supported by strong knowledge foundations, monitoring, and clear intervention mechanisms.